PRACTICE 04 · 10-MINUTE

The Guilt *Practice*

Guilt→Release

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	Any time	Beginner	3

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Guilt is the feeling that you should have done something differently, even when no one is asking that of you. It often shows up after the moment has passed. In replaying conversations. In carrying responsibility that quietly grows heavier over time.

Guilt usually comes from care. From wanting to do right by others. From holding yourself to high standards. This practice is here to help you separate care from self-blame and let your body release what it's been holding.

> *"I can care without punishing myself."*

A note before you begin. Guilt lives in the body as heaviness and tension. The shaking movement in step two may feel strange. Do it anyway. It's one of the most effective ways to discharge stored emotion from the nervous system.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to write with
- Something to track time
- 10 uninterrupted minutes
- A warm drink, tea, coffee, or cacao. Hold it as you begin.

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> Guilt isn't always about mistakes. More often it comes from over-responsibility. When you slow down and look at the thoughts driving it, you create room for something kinder without letting go of your values.

1	Thought Work	6 min
2	Qi Gong Shake	1 min
3	Close	1 min

THE PRACTICE

01 Thought Work

6 MINUTES

Hold something warm. Let it settle before you begin.

The mind revisits what you said, what you did, what you could have done differently, trying to prevent future regret. The body carries this as heaviness. As a quiet sense of needing to make things right. This sequence moves through it step by step.

Sit comfortably and take a sip of your warm drink. Let the warmth settle.

In your journal, gently walk through:

- What am I feeling guilty about right now? Be specific. One situation is enough.
- What thoughts am I telling myself about this? (I should have known better. I disappointed someone. I didn't do enough.)
- How do these thoughts affect how I act? (Pushing harder, over-explaining, apologising excessively, holding it in.)
- What is a more honest or balanced thought I could try instead?
- If I held that new thought, what action would it allow? (Rest, a boundary, a conversation, letting it go.)

conversation, letting it go.)

Examples of balanced thoughts:

- I made the best decision I could with what I knew at the time.
- I can acknowledge this without blaming myself.
- I can care and still have limits.
- This doesn't define my character.

Choose one that feels believable, not comforting. Write simply. You're not correcting yourself. You're creating options.

02 Qi Gong Shake

1 MINUTE

Standing, shaking out the body

Guilt tends to settle low in the body. Shaking is one of the most direct ways to discharge stored tension from the nervous system. Animals do this instinctively after stress. We've been taught to suppress it. This is you giving yourself permission to let it move through.

Qi Gong Shake · Demo video

YouTube · ~1 minute · Opens in new tab

Watch →

Stand comfortably with your feet grounded. Begin gently shaking your hands, arms, shoulders, and legs.

Let the movement be loose and unstructured. You don't need rhythm. You don't need control.

After about a minute, slow the movement and come to stillness. Notice how your body feels standing still.

03 Close

1 MINUTE

Place one hand on your heart and take one slow breath. Take one final sip of your warm drink.

Quietly repeat:

."I'm allowed to learn and let it go."

Then gently return to your day.

PRACTICE COMPLETE

Today, you put down something that didn't need to be carried any longer.

That matters. Responsibility doesn't require self-judgment. Care doesn't require weight. Return to this practice whenever guilt starts quietly taking up space.

Creating inner balance, one gentle release at a time.

ENJOY YOUR DAY